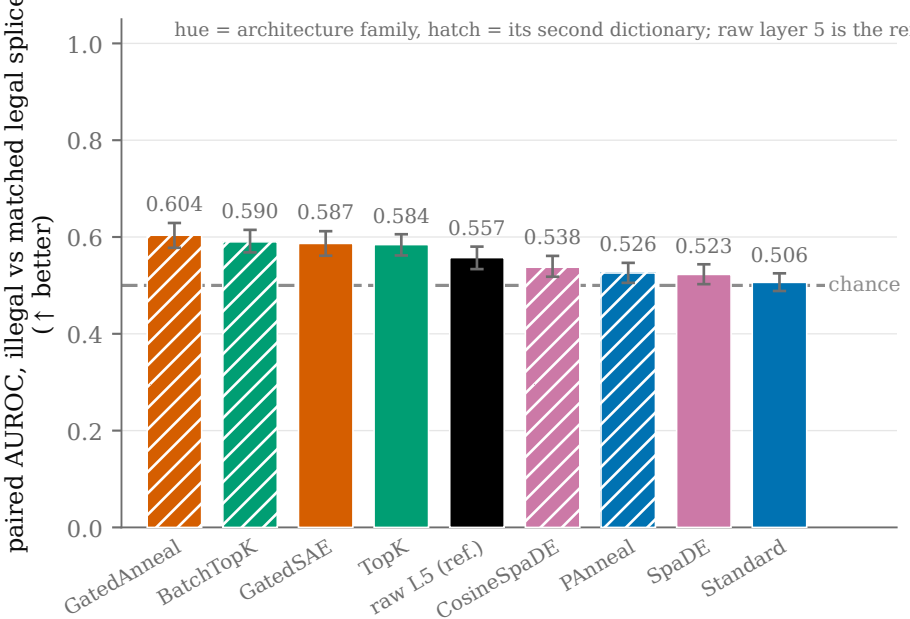

Score: how much shorter than usual the step through the space is, standardized per move index against legal games, then contrasted across each candidate move (MOSUM, m = 4 plies each side) and scanned blind over the whole game -- no knowledge that a move was spliced, and no counterfactual branch. The window was chosen on the disjoint straightness corpus. One illegal branch per game at seed 42; whiskers are 95% percentile bootstrap CIs over 575 paired games (1,000 resamples). The chance line is empirical: the legal control scored against the second legal control each game carries gives 0.492-0.512. AUROCs are never flipped, so a bar at 0.5 is the finding.